Hadji Urang Menor Naga

Hadji Urang Menor Naga (January 2, 1901 – February 15, 1987) was a Maranao leader, public servant, and civic innovator whose influence shaped governance, infrastructure, and community life in Lanao. He is remembered as the "Most Honest Provincial Treasurer of Lanao del Sur" and as a quiet builder of modern institutions in Marawi City.

Contents

1 Early Life
2 Government Service
3 Civic Contributions
4 Education and Faith
5 Agricultural Innovation
6 War and Resistance
7 Legacy

Early Life

Born in 1901, Naga grew up during a time of administrative and social transformation in Mindanao. His fluency in English allowed him to bridge local governance with national and international networks.

Government Service

He served as Provincial Treasurer of the undivided Lanao, later continuing in Lanao del Sur after the province was divided in 1959. His reputation for integrity became legendary, earning him recognition upon retirement in the mid-1960s as the "Most Honest Provincial Treasurer of Lanao del Sur."

Civic Contributions

Naga's vision extended beyond government. In Marawi City, he helped establish:

- The first printing press
- The first electric company
- The first radio station
- The first taxi company
- MATELCO, the first telephone company

These initiatives modernized civic life, giving Marawi access to communication, mobility, and information.

Hadji Urang Menor Naga



Name	Hadji Urang Menor Naga
Born	January 2, 1901
Died	February 15, 1987
Occupation	Provincial Treasurer of Lanao, Provincial Treasurer of Lanao del Sur
Titles	3rd Sultan sa Bayabao
Known For	Honesty in public service, pioneering civic institutions in Marawi, agricultural innovation
Religion	Islam (Hadji, completed pilgrimage to Mecca)

Education and Faith

He was a member of the first Board of Incorporators of the Kamilol Islamic Society School, supporting education for future generations. As a Hadji, he embodied moral leadership, and as the 3rd Sultan sa Bayabao, he carried traditional authority within Maranao society.

Agricultural Innovation

Together with his son-in-law and grandson, Sacar M. Basman of the International Rice Research Institute, Naga helped introduce “Miracle Rice” in Bubong, Lanao del Sur. This shortened harvest cycles to three months, transforming livelihoods in the Basak area.

War and Resistance

Naga was a war veteran during the Japanese and American occupations and fought in the Tamparan War in Lanao del Sur, carrying forward the resilience of his people.

Legacy

His name itself reflects contrasts: “Urang” (scorpion) for vigilance and defense, “Naga” (water dragon) for depth and adaptability. He passed away on February 15, 1987, leaving behind no stone monument, but a legacy etched in institutions, honesty, and community progress.

- Profile provided by Hayree Alug Basman (https://www.facebook.com/eyepatch11)

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